

Title

Evaluation of an Alternative Costimulation-Blocking Strategy for Preventing Psoriasis Recurrence Following Biologic Agent Withdrawal: A Randomized Controlled Protocol

Abstract

Alternative biologic therapies target different pathogenic pathways in psoriasis, and transitioning between agents may offer clinical advantages. This protocol describes a double-blind, placebo-controlled randomized trial investigating whether costimulatory blockade with an alternative biologic can maintain psoriasis control after withdrawal of a first-line biologic therapy. Adults with moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis who demonstrate response to an initial biologic agent will enter a lead-in phase. Those achieving clinical improvement are then randomly assigned to either continue the original biologic therapy or switch to an alternative costimulatory-blocking agent, with both maintained through mid-study then withdrawn. The primary outcome is proportion of participants experiencing disease relapse over subsequent follow-up. Secondary endpoints assess time to relapse and molecular disease markers. We hypothesize the alternative mechanism of action will sustain clinical benefit comparable to continued original therapy.